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AATSEEL chapter officers are requested to send regular reports of chapter activities to the editor for inclusion in the AATSEEL Chapter News. Please submit reports double-spaced in standard manuscript form. Please give professional affiliations of all persons mentioned.

Transliteration. The following system used in SEEJ for transliterating Russian: a-a, 6-b, в-в, г-г, д-d, е-е, ж-ž, з-z, и-i, й-j, к-k, л-l, м-m, н-n, о-o, п-p, р-r, с-s, т-t, у-u, ф-f, х-x, ц-c, ч-č, ш-š, щ-šč, ь-', ы-y, ь-', з-è, ю-ju, я-ja. Exception is made for anglicized words, such as *Bolshevik*, *Kolkhoz*, *Moscow*, *ruble*, and *tsar*, and for bibliographical references where the spelling of the title being cited is retained e.g., *The Letters of Chekhov*.

NOTES ON THE IMPERFECT IN EARLY EAST SLAVIC

Horace G. Lunt, *Harvard University*

It is a commonplace of textbooks about the history of Russian or Ukrainian that two simple past tenses, aorist and imperfect, existed in the early centuries and then were lost.¹ Yet the precise shapes of the native East Slavic imperfect, as contrasted to the Old Church Slavonic forms which served as the original models for the written language of Rus', are never set forth clearly.² As a result, even Soviet specialists in Russian texts have become needlessly confused, and recent works contain gross errors. It is therefore worthwhile to sketch the major points.³

The OCS forms are well known. In the outline below, I will review the major facts. I assume that every OCS (or other Slavic) regular verbal form consists of a single invariant basic stem followed by suffixes which have specific grammatical meanings.⁴ Thus every imperfect form contains elements corresponding to the formula (basic stem) + (imperfect-marker) + (person-marker).⁵ The imperfect-marker is *-ěa-x-*, but in definable contexts the *ě* may be replaced by *a*, while the *x* may be replaced by *š* or *s*. Further, the *ě* may be eliminated if it follows certain suffixal elements of the basic stem. Let us consider only the third-person singular forms.

Surface forms in *-ěa-še* reflect underlying stems which for our purposes here may be grouped into four types: 1) in *-ě+* or *-ěj+*, for example, *vid-ě+* 'see,' *um-ěj+* 'understand,' 2) in *-nq+*, for example, *sax-nq+* 'dry up,' 3) in a non-velar consonant, for example, *ved+* 'lead,' and 4) certain irregular verbs like *ved-ě+* 'know,' *čtu+* 'count,' *id+* 'go,' and *bě+* 'to be.' Thus:

1. *viděaše, uměaše*
2. *suxněaše*
3. *veděaše*
4. *veděaše, čitěaše, iděaše, běaše*

All other imperfects end in *-aaše*. One frequent type has a non-palatal consonant preceding the imperfect suffix (5. *glagol-a+* 'speak,' *běg-aj+* 'flee') while four groups have a palatal consonant (6. *děj-a+* 'do,' *běž-a+* 'flee,' *stoj-a+* 'stand,' *klanj-aj+* 'bow'; 7. *bij+* 'beat,' *kryj+* 'hide'; 8. *tek+* 'run,' *mog+* 'be able'; 9. *mol-i+* 'beg,' *gon-i+* 'pursue,' *tvor-i+* 'make,' *svęt-i+* 'consecrate,' *ljub-i+* 'love,' *xod-i+* 'walk,' *nos-i+* 'carry,' *voz-i+* 'convey'). Thus:

5. *glagolaše, bēgaše*
6. *dējaaše, bēžaaše, stojaaše, klanjaaše*
7. *bijaaše, kryjaaše*
8. *tečaaše, možaaše*
9. *moljaaše, gonjaaše, tvorjaaše, ljubljaaše, svěštaaše, xoždaaše, nošaaše, vožaaše.*

Within OCS, the two-syllable sequences *-ěa-* and *-aa-* lost the second syllable,⁶ so they could be spelled *-ě-* and *-a-*, for example *viděše, běše, glagolaše, tečaše, moljaše*. Approximately one out of four OCS imperfects appears in contracted form; the Cyrillic Savvina kniga has no uncontracted imperfects.⁷

In Rus', the imperfect-marker must have been *-āa-*, the first element (or the only element in contracted forms)⁸ being functionally identical with the reflex of the front nasal *ę* which had survived in OCS (ESl *jāzky, mā, tā, sā, žātva* versus OCS *językъ, mę, tę, sę, žętva*), as well as older *a* after a palatal consonant (*jāko, klanjāti, čāsā, žāba*). Russian scribes spelled this vowel with "jus malyj" or "ja" (or, in the earliest manuscripts, "jus malyj iotirovannyj" for *jā*), except that after a palatal "a" could be used.⁹ For these examples in Cyrillic, see the appendix.

In practical terms, this means that only those OCS imperfects with surface *-ěa-* needed to be modified (by substituting *āa/ā*) in order to have native East Slavic forms. Accordingly we find—alongside the OCS spellings in most of the eleventh-century manuscripts, but quickly replacing them in most later manuscripts—the types (1) *vidāaše, umāaše*, (2) *sūxnāaše*, (3) *vedāaše*, (4) *vedāaše, čitāaše, idāaše, bāaše*. See appendix, 2.

OCS imperfects with spelled *ja* or with *a* after a palatal became subject to the Russian alternative spellings: *bēzaaše ~ bēžaše*, etc.; see appendix, 3.

This accounts for most of the imperfects, but there is a significant group where purely mechanical substitution of *-āa-* for *-ěa-*, along with the spelling conventions, fails to predict the shapes actually found in the Russian manuscripts. This is the group of *i*-verbs from type 9 which have consonant mutation: stems like *ljub-i+*, *svet-i+*, *xod-i+*, *nos-i+*, *voz-i+*. By OCS rules, *nos-i+ěa-še* yields *nošaše* and *nošaše*.¹⁰ However, in Rus', forms without mutation were not uncommon: *ljubāaše, svātāaše, xodāaše, nosāaše, vozāaše*, (see appendix, 4); they were probably native to some if not most East Slavic dialects.¹¹ After about 1400, scribes ordinarily replaced non-mutated forms with the traditional OCS shapes, for this was the norm dictated by the new Bulgarian models, which rejected South Slavic spoken dialect imperfects. Nonetheless, spellings like *nosjaše* persist even into works written in the eighteenth century.¹²

Soviet scholars incorrectly believe that contracted forms are a sure sign of the Russian character of a manuscript.¹³ Since Russian scribes were working from models like our OCS manuscripts, there are contracted forms beside uncontracted ones from the beginning, so that the Ostromir Gospel of 1056 has OCS *veděše* and *vedēaše* beside a domesticated *vedjaaše*, and the Uspenskij Sbornik has the last form and also *vedjaše* (appendix, 5).¹⁴ Uncontracted and non-mutated forms in original Russian writings (for example, *otpuštaše*, Life of Feodosij, Usp. Sb.) may mean that the suffix *-āa-* really existed in eleventh-century Rus', but the longer spellings may be purely mechanical imitations of OCS and the suffix could be posited only as *-ā-*. What is certain is that non-contracted forms were common for a long time and were preferred by some scribes.

Finally, it is essentially a Russian characteristic to add the third-person desinenca *-iti*: *bāašeti, bāšetj, bāaxuti, bāxuti, glagolaxuti, nošāaxuti*, and the like (appendix, 6).¹⁵ In view of the inconsistent use of this desinenca, it is possible that it was not present in all dialects.¹⁶

Thus, early Russian texts surely allowed imperfect forms with variations affecting (1) the imperfect-marker (contraction in OCS and ESl, OCS *ě* versus ESl *ā*), (2) the stem (mutation of *i*-stems, obligatory in standard OCS, optional in ESl),¹⁷ and (3) the desinenca (OCS *zero* versus ESl [optional] *-iti*).¹⁸ The array of permutations attested in Russian manuscripts is quite within the range of understanding of the average student.

APPENDIX

1. АЗЫКЪ = ꙖЗЫКЪ = ꙖЗЫКЪ, МА = МѦ, ТА = ТѦ, СА = СѦ, ЖАТВА = ЖАТВА, ꙖКО = ꙖКО = ꙖКО, КЛАНИТИ = КЛАНИТИ, ЧАША = ЧАША = ЧАША = ЧАША, ЖАБА = ЖАБА.
2. ВИДААШЕ = ВИДААШЕ, ВИДАШЕ = ВИДАШЕ, ОУМААШЕ = ОУМААШЕ, ОУМАШЕ = ОУМАШЕ, СЪХНААШЕ = СЪХНААШЕ, ВЕДААШЕ = ВЕДААШЕ, ВЪДААШЕ = ВЪДААШЕ, ЧЪТААШЕ = ЧЪТААШЕ, ИДААШЕ = ИДААШЕ, БААШЕ = БААШЕ, БАШЕ = БАШЕ.
3. БЪЖААШЕ = БЪЖААШЕ, БЪЖАШЕ = БЪЖАШЕ, СТОААШЕ = СТОААШЕ, КЛАНААШЕ = КЛАНААШЕ, ТЕЧААШЕ = ТЕЧААШЕ, ЛЮБЛААШЕ = ЛЮБЛААШЕ.
4. ЛЮБНААШЕ = ЛЮБНААШЕ, СВАТНААШЕ = СВАТНААШЕ, ХОДНААШЕ = ХОДНААШЕ, НОСНААШЕ = НОСНААШЕ, ВОЗНААШЕ = ВОЗНААШЕ.
5. ВЪДѦШЕ, ВЪДѦШЕ; ВЪДНАШЕ, ВЪДААШЕ, ВЪДАШЕ.
6. БААШЕТЪ = БААШЕТЪ, БААХОУТЪ = БААХОУТЪ, БАШЕТЪ = БАШЕТЪ, БАХОУТЪ = БАХОУТЪ, ГЛАГОЛАХОУТЪ, НОШААХОУТЪ = НОШААХОУТЪ.

NOTES

- 1 The oldest example attributable to a native East Slav is *pravljaaše* 'ruled,' in the scribe Grigorij's colophon to the Ostromir Gospel of 1056-57 (reproduced in C. E. Gribble, *Medieval Slavic Texts* [Cambridge, MA: Slavica 1973], 23) — a fact which is regularly ignored in textbooks. The imperfect appears to have lost ground steadily during the thirteenth century, but the powerful influence of the church language on annalistic writing, our chief source of data, makes it impossible to document the loss of the category. Imperfects are generally absent from *gramoty* and legal texts simply because the subject matter does not require complex expression of past actions. In any case, the imperfect (and the aorist, which surely survived much longer) belonged only to the common ancestor of Russian, Byelorussian, and Ukrainian, which was the language of Rus' and which I will refer to as Russian. For this term see also my remarks in *Russian Linguistics*, 2 (1975), 269-81, and in *Language*, 52 (1976), 708 ff. For the meaning of the imperfect, which will not be mentioned here, see C. H. van Schooneveld, t06A Semantic Analysis of the Old Russian Finite Preterite System (The Hague: Mouton, 1959), and, especially for perfective imperfects (a category believed impossible by some scholars), Ju. S. Maslov, "Imperfekt glagolov soveršennogo vida v slavjanskix jazykax," *Voprosy slavjanskogo jazykoznanija*, 1 (1954), 68-138.
- 2 The basic facts are briefly noted by Nikolaj Durnovo, *Očerki istorii russkogo jazyka* (1924, rpt.; The Hague: Mouton, 1959) 320-21, 325—but the reader is expected to know OCS. The standard V. I. Borkovskij and P. S. Kuznecov, *Istoričeskaja grammatika russkogo jazyka*, (M.: AN SSSR, 1965), 272-75, provides heterogeneous information that has proved to be utterly confusing to students. The sample paradigm is insufficient to illustrate the problems. The treatment in other handbooks is not substantially better.
- 3 A more detailed discussion is forthcoming in *Harvard Ukrainian Studies*.
- 4 This assumption is spelled out in detail in my *Old Church Slavonic Grammar*, 6th ed. (The Hague: Mouton, 1974), 147-48 and, for the imperfect, 168 ff. Verbs which clearly have two stems (for example, *zŭv-a+ti* but *zov+otŭ*) are by definition irregular and will not be treated here. The more traditional assumption is that several classes of verbs have two

stems, one present and one aorist-infinitive (see for example, André Vaillant, *Manuel du vieux slave*, 2nd ed. [Paris, 1964]). Sofija P. Lopusanskaja, *Osnovnye tendencii evoljucii prostyx preteritov v drevnerusskom knižnom jazyke* (Kazan, 1975), operates with a rather fuzzily defined system that is both cumbersome and oversimplified; I will not attempt to discuss it here.

- 5 See my *OCS Grammar*, 86-87. A more complex analysis based on a somewhat different subset of theoretical assumptions is given on 168 ff.
- 6 The original dissyllabic value is assured by the fact that musical manuscripts provide two notes. The musical settings presumably reflect the language of the tenth century.
- 7 One exception, *iskaaxp*, has the second *a* added above the line as an afterthought. Perhaps *znajaše* (Mt. 1:25, cf. *znaaše*, Assem.) is a hypercorrection, similar to odd forms in the Suprasliensis, but the matter is complex; see forthcoming *Harvard Ukrainian Studies*.
- 8 Notice that for both OCS and Russian a single shape of the suffix (-*ěa*- or -*āa*-) is assumed, along with rules (not given here) which will account for the spelled forms with -*aa*- or -*a*-. Books like Borkovskij and Kuznecov assume two shapes at the outset and then, unfortunately, fail to give a clear account of the distribution.
- 9 Individual scribes usually followed fairly obvious rules, often: "ĕ" after consonant letter, "ja" otherwise.
- 10 In terms of either historical or synchronic rules, *i* becomes *j* before *ě*, mutation takes place before *j*, and *j* disappears; *ě* then backs to *a* after palatal.
- 11 Non-mutated forms from Bulgaria, Macedonia, and Serbia are characteristic of many post-OCS South Slavic manuscripts, and two examples occur in the Suprasliensis, for example, *prixoděaxp* for *prixoždaaxp* (see Vaillant, 245). Perhaps such forms existed in the spoken language of some Bulgarian teachers of the East Slavs in the eleventh century, but they are rare indeed in Russian copies of standard OCS texts. The Archangel Gospel of 1092 has *prěteše* 'rebuked' (L 23:40), cf. the Ostromir Gospel of 1056, *prěščase*.
- 12 The editors of the Vygoleksa Sbornik (see note 13 below), which contains two texts of OCS origin, explicitly label the correct form *krašęše* (from *kras-i+* 'decorate, paint') an error with *š* written for *s* (31); they apparently were confused because a later copy of the text has *krasjaše* (144). In the seventeenth-century Tale of Karp Sutulov, *nošaše* and *nosjaše* both occur, see Ad. Stender-Petersen, *Anthology of Old Russian Literature* (New York: Columbia Univ. Press, 1954), 457, lines 1 and 4.
- 13 See for example the introductions to three recent editions of eleventh and twelfth-century manuscripts, all directed by S. I. Kotkov: *Izbornik 1076 goda* (M., 1965), 116; *Uspenskij sbornik XII-XIII vv.* (M., 1971), 25 (this is, incidentally, a remarkably conservative manuscript, more characteristic of the middle than the end of the twelfth century); *Vygoleksinskij sbornik* (M., 1977), 40.
- 14 In texts shared by the Suprasliensis and Uspenskij Sbornik some imperfects are contracted in OCS and uncontracted in the Russian copy, for example, Su 389.24 *klanjaxę* versus Usp. 190v15 *klanqaxu*.
- 15 Even with undomesticated OCS forms, like *běšetī* (in Vygoleksa sb.). For possible *t*-suffixes in South Slavic, see *Harvard Ukrainian Studies*.
- 16 The present-desinence -*tŭ* of OCS and the corresponding -*ti* of Rus' almost certainly was not obligatory in all verbs in all dialects, although the evidence is insufficient to allow a more precise statement of distribution.
- 17 Variation in *ova*-verbs, for example, *besędovaše* versus *besędujaše*, found both in OCS and Russian, will not be treated here, nor will questions of individual irregular verbs such as *zŭvaaše* versus *zovęaše/zovāaše*.
- 18 The older -*šete* and -*šeta* versus newer -*ste* and -*sta* desinences of second plural and third and second dual, duly mentioned in the handbooks of Russian, are also OCS; it is of interest that the archaic shapes proved so tenacious in Rus'.

AATSEEL CHAPTERS

The *Arizona Chapter* met on 1 December 1979 in Tucson, president Roger Hagglund (Univ. of Arizona) presiding. Chapter members were joined by graduate and undergraduate students in the presentation of a *literaturnyj večer* in honor of the 180th anniversary of the birth of Puškin. Students read the originals *in* and their own translations of Puškin's poetry. Readers were: Peggy Lewis, Suzanne Albright, Katie Gaul, John Yackley, Bob Katz, Carol Turnberg, Dorothy Gisler, Michael Ganski, and Roza Simkhovich. Other poems by Blok, Axmatova, Pasternak, and Esenin were read by Kathy Morse, and Kathy Zack. The program began with "An Illustrated Introduction to Puškin" by Roger Hagglund. Arizeder Urreizitieta sang Gremin's aria from *Evgenij Onegin* and *Oči černye*. (Respectfully submitted by Margaret I. Gibson, secretary.)

The *Iowa Chapter* met at Cedar Falls on Saturday, 13 October 1979, in conjunction with the annual meeting of the Iowa Teachers of Foreign Languages. The program included a discussion of first-year courses and a film taken on the Trans-Siberian Railroad by Professor Jamosky (Univ. of Northern Iowa). Officer elected for 1979-80 were Ray Parrott (Univ. of Iowa), president, and Sheila McCarthy (Grinnell Coll.), secretary. (Respectfully submitted by Ann Vinograde, secretary.)

The 1979 meeting of the *Michigan Chapter* took place Friday, 2 November 1979, at the University of Michigan in Ann Arbor. The heart of the program was a panel discussion on the topic, "The Present State and Future Prospects of Slavic Studies." Panel members were Benjamin Stolz and Deming Brown (Univ. of Michigan), Frank Corliss (Wayne State Univ.), and Frank Ingram (Michigan State Univ.). A lively discussion followed the panel's presentation. At a brief business meeting president Kenneth Brostrom discussed various ways in which the Chapter could play a more productive role in addressing the issues facing us. Officers re-elected for 1980 were: Kenneth Brostrom (Wayne State Univ.) president; Herbert Eagle (Univ. of Michigan), vice-president; and Ellen Cochrum (Michigan State Univ.), secretary-treasurer. (Respectfully submitted by Olga Z. Ovenhouse, Lansing Eastern H.S., substitute recorder.)

The fall meeting of the *Missouri Chapter* was held on Saturday, 27 October 1979, at Country Day School in St. Louis, Nadia Danett, president, presiding. Milica Banjanin (Washington Univ.) reported on "The State of the Archives in the Soviet Union." After describing the project, Dr. Banjanin related valuable information for anyone wishing to work in Soviet archives. "The State of Foreign Languages in the Midwest," a report on President Carter's Committee on the Advancement of Foreign Languages, was presented by Nadia Danett (St. Louis Day School). President Danett gave a valuable and informative observation on the state of foreign languages in the midwest. She spoke of ways to improve the study of languages in American institutions, the importance of bringing Russian Language courses back to those high schools that have discontinued their offerings, and on how to increase enrollment in Russian studies in those schools that still offer Russian. "Russian Summer Camp 1979" was presented by George W. Morris (St. Louis University H.S.). Mr. Morris gave a brief summary of the tenth annual Russian Camp celebration and presented a financial report on the current status of the camp. Plans for next year's Summer Camp were discussed, as were plans for the 1979 "Olimpiada" on spoken and written Russian. All presentations were followed by lively discussion. The meeting concluded with a business meeting. (Respectfully submitted by Nelly Grosswasser, secretary-treasurer.)

The fall meeting of the *Greater Washington, D.C. Chapter* was held on 17 November 1979 at The George Washington University in conjunction with the University's Dilthey Society. The program was a commemorative colloquium dedicated to the centenary of Dostoevsky's novel *The Brothers Karamazov*. The colloquium was introduced by Roderick S. French (GWU) and Nadine Natov (GWU), and the following papers were presented: Charles Moser (GWU), "Unbelief and Crime in Dostoevsky," Thelma Z. Lavine (GWU), "*The Brothers Karamazov*:"

The Death Struggle of Ideologies," Dmitry Grigorieff (Georgetown Univ.), "Father Zosima—Spiritual Mentor of Alesha Karamazov," Robert Louis Jackson (Yale Univ.), "The Sentencing of Fedor Karamazov," Geoffrey Carter (GWU) "Freud and *The Brothers Karamazov*." After an open discussion dinner was served in the University Club. (Respectfully submitted by Elizabeth Barnes, secretary.)

The Tenth Annual Russian Language Camp of the Missouri Chapter was held at Camp Mo-Val near Union, Missouri. Eighteen of the twenty-five participants in the two-week camp were previous participants, and some returned for third, fourth, and fifth years. Students played *lapta*, took part in a playground-style *Olimpiada*, made *pisjanki*, participated in Russian-language treasure hunts, took a five-hour float trip, danced Russian folk dances and sang Russian folk songs—all this in addition to three hours of language instruction every day and five full-length films in Russian. Classes were conducted in small groups according to level and were taught by high school teachers, college students, and one well qualified high-school graduate. Topics explored in depth were verbs of motion and time expressions. Special lectures on Soviet geography and Russian literature were given by Nelly Grosswasser. Numerous guests and parents were present on the final Saturday. Nadia Danett, chapter president, spoke about the need for Russian study and the benefits of the camp. Shelly Champion Dwyer, a former participant, spoke of her experiences over a six-year period. Lena Grosswasser, a current camper, spoke of her association with the camp from the age of eight. Because of her seniority she was chosen to present George W. Morris, camp director, with a briefcase, a gift from all the campers. Nadia Danett then presented Mr. Morris with a plaque on behalf of the chapter members. A program of skits, dancing, and singing completed the event. (Submitted by Nelly Grosswasser, secretary-treasurer, Missouri chapter.)